Women's Specialists of Clear Lake
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Low Libido & Sexual Health

Understanding the causes, risk factors, and treatment options

40%
OF WOMEN
affected in the U.S.

Sexual concerns are common and **nothing to be embarrassed about.** About 40% of women experience sexual health challenges — from changes in desire and arousal to pain during intercourse. These issues can be addressed, and **effective treatments exist.** The first step is a conversation with your provider.

UNDERSTANDING THE TERMINOLOGY

Desire (Libido)
Interest in sexual activity. Can be spontaneous or responsive — responsive desire (needing the right mood/context) is very common in long-term relationships and is completely normal.

Arousal
The physical and emotional response to sexual stimulation, including increased blood flow, lubrication, and heightened sensation.

Orgasm
The peak of sexual pleasure, often accompanied by rhythmic muscle contractions. Difficulty reaching orgasm is one of the most common concerns women share.

Dyspareunia (Pain)
Discomfort or pain during intercourse. This is always worth addressing — it's not something you should simply tolerate, and effective treatments are available.

COMMON CONTRIBUTING FACTORS

Fatigue & Stress
Chronic tiredness and stress suppress desire and satisfaction

Medications
Antidepressants, hormonal contraceptives, and others can affect libido

Hormonal Changes
Menopause, childbirth, and hysterectomy alter hormone levels

Relationship Dynamics
Communication, trust, and emotional connection are foundational

Mental Health
Depression, anxiety, and body image concerns all play a role

Pelvic Health
Vaginal dryness, pelvic floor tension, and pelvic pain

TREATMENT OPTIONS

1. **Lifestyle & Stress Management**
   Prioritize sleep, reduce workload, add yoga or meditation. Small changes in daily routine can significantly improve desire.
2. **Communication & Counseling**
   Open dialogue with your partner plus sex therapy or counseling. Highly effective — often the most impactful intervention.
3. **Vaginal & Pelvic Treatments**
   OTC lubricants, low-dose vaginal estrogen, or pelvic floor physical therapy for dryness or pain-related low desire.
4. **Medication Review**
   If a current medication is affecting your libido, alternatives or dosage adjustments may help — always discuss with your provider first.
5. **Hormonal Therapy**
   Testosterone or DHEA under medical guidance for postmenopausal women. FDA-approved options (Flibanserin, Bremelanotide) available for HSDD.

You don't have to navigate this alone.

Sexual health is a complex interplay of physical, emotional, and relational factors — and every woman's experience is different. Dr. Klein and his team are here to listen without judgment and help you find the right path forward. Please reach out.